

# Hegel and Modern Topology

Clarence Protin

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## Abstract

In this paper we show how some fundamental concepts of modern topology can be understood philosophically in the light of Hegel's Logic as well how modern topological concepts can provide concrete illustrations of many of the concepts and deductions that Hegel used. This paper can be seen as a continuation of our paper [13] where we argued that the prototypes of many fundamental notions of modern topology were already found in Aristotle's Physics. This paper is divided into two parts. The first part (sections 2 - 9) focuses only on elementary topology while the remaining sections discuss advanced category theory. Update (July 2025). Since this note was written the author has had occasion to deepen their understanding of these matters (in particular during reading groups on Hegel's Phenomenology and Spirit and Science of Logic) and it is their view that there is now much to be both corrected and added. In particular some very interesting connections to the philosophy of Proclus (and in particular the theory of dialectics and the Proclean view of mathematics in his Commentary of the the first book of the Elements). Also we recommend the very interesting PhD thesis by Fabio Mascarenhas Nolasco, A suspensão qualitativa da quantidade: a crítica de Hegel ao paradigma matemático da ciência moderna (2015). All this would require a radical rewriting of the entire paper. Instead of this we must be content for now with merely presenting some additions at the beginning.

## 1 Updates

As stated in the abstract, in this section we present some short notes hinting at aspects of this paper that need to be either clarified or expanded.

The something and the other. In the Science of Logic Hegel thinks of the idea of two things bearing the same relation to each other and indistinguishable in any other way. Now a good illustration of this situation is found in the two possible orientations of a vector space. Each bears the same relation to the other and there is absolutely no way to uniquely identify one of them in distinction to the other. In the same place Hegel talks about the meaning of proper names and states that they have none !

Hegel's strategy. All of Hegel is based on the dynamics and structure of consciousness as it reveals itself to itself. But equally important it is all based on positing this structure of consciousness to be essentially objective and not subjective. Thus 'being a subject' is seen as a stage in the development of the object while mere 'subjectivity' is seen as a failure and partiality of objective consciousness in not living up to its full objectivity or actuality (or knowledge and realization thereof).

Thus ideality and infinity are the key structure of an object which has developed to a point of being a subject.

Finitude and limit: a closed set. Yet the boundary also defines what the set is not (cf. discussion on Heyting algebra of open sets, etc.). Thus the boundary contains implicitly its own negation.

Limitation : an open set (also analytic continuation). Limit outside itself.

The ought... manifestation of the germ of a space through a given open set representation of the equivalence class. Any particular one is insufficient and can be replaced by another which is also insufficient.

False infinity: taking simply the set (or diagram) of such open set representatives. True infinity taking the limit (equivalence class) or limit (in the categorical sense)..

Degrees of interpenetration and transparency between the individual and the universal (and between self-consciousness and essence) in the Phenomenology of Spirit. From the rudimentary form in the ethical life to: the universal is in the individual, the individual in the universal and the universal is in the relation between individuals and the relation between individuals is in the universal (mutual confession and forgiveness).

Milne's notes on Class Field Theory has a quote of Chevalley (1940) which seems couched in Hegelian terms: the Abelian extensions of a number field are determined by the number field itself, the number field 'contains within itself the elements of its own transcendence'.

And yet : and yet it is really basic to use ontology and logic inspired by (or abstracted from) biology and psychology - that is, a kind of general systems theory and universal logic based fundamentally on biology and consciousness. The fact that mathematics exhibits philosophical analogy with biology suggests that biological ontology and logic is fundamental. René Thom already did this by suggesting that concepts have analogies with living organisms.

'Pure' category theory is very poor in results, like Hegel's poor, empty, abstract universal. But once we consider the particular, like Abelian or Monoidal categories, things become very rich.

Extensive magnitude: the category including in itself objects and arrows. Intensive magnitude, one object signaled out, hence only meaningful in the context of a category. Infinite progression: a diagram in a category. Ratio the limit. For infinitesimals the limit for the category of open sets does not exist but for the functor it does. Ratio is also the quotient construction in which representatives are sublated moments.

## 2 General considerations on Hegel's Logic

Hegel expresses apparently negative views of mathematics in his published works (specially in the Science of Logic). However we need to balance our judgment with the following extract from his letters (see Wallace's translation of the Encyclopedia Logic, xiv-xv) which is very revealing:

*'I am a schoolmaster who has to teach philosophy, who, possibly for that reason, believes that philosophy like geometry is teachable, and must no less than geometry have a regular structure. But again, a knowledge of the facts in geometry and philosophy is one thing, and the mathematical or philosophical talent which procreates and discovers is another : my province is to discover that scientific form, or to aid in the formation of it'.*

*' You know that I have had too much to do not merely with ancient literature, but even with mathematics, latterly with the higher analysis, differential calculus, chemistry, to let myself be taken in by the humbug of Naturphilosophie, philosophising without knowledge of fact and by mere force of imagination, and treating mere fancies, even imbecile fancies, as Ideas.'*

Our view is that Hegel is essentially concerned with the phenomenology of consciousness (including forms of social, historical, cultural and religious consciousness) and that the Science of Logic represent an attempt at abstracting the structures and processes found therein. True, there is a sense in which consciousness is left behind at the beginning of the Logic, that it proceeds from where the Phenomenology of Spirit left off, that even pure being is incomprehensible

by consciousness. Be this as it may, it is still the case, so we contend, that consciousness is the ultimate source of the Logic. Consider this passage from the Encyclopedia Logic:

*In other words, every man, when he thinks and considers his thoughts, will discover by the experience of his consciousness that they possess the character of universality as well as the other aspects of thought to be afterwards enumerated. We assume of course that his powers of attention and abstraction have undergone a previous training, enabling him to observe correctly the evidence of his consciousness and his conceptions.*

Also we read in the Lessons in the History of Philosophy:

*The two formal moments in this sceptical culture are firstly the power of consciousness to go back from itself, and to take as its object the whole that is present, itself and its operation included. The second moment is to grasp the form in which a proposition, with whose content our consciousness is in any way occupied, exists. An undeveloped consciousness, on the other hand, usually knows nothing of what is present in addition to the content.*

The following appear to us to be some of the fundamental processes of consciousness which also correspond to certain fundamental mathematical structures or constructions:

- Synthesis. This is reflected in the gluing of geometric objects, various kinds of covers and specially the sheaf condition.
- Self-reflection. A system which can represent (partially at least) higher order aspects of itself within itself. A prime example is the original synthetic unity of apperception: *I know that I am knowing*. This is reflected in recursive and inductive definitions.
- Return-to-self. This is related to the negation of the negation (double negation). An example is found in temporality: something must pass away to reveal its essence - to ti ên einai, literally 'the what it was to be'.

Let us recall the basic trinary structure of Hegel's Logic (see [4] for a deeper discussion). The Understanding seizes a concept as an immediate whole, but then Dialectical reason remembers the complex process of its genesis and its inward relations and tensions (that it, it becomes a category of objects and morphisms). Speculative reason then replies to Dialectical reason that these relations actually flow in both ways rendering the category again a coherent whole - maybe we can view this as realizing the quotient construction in which we find formal inverses to the relations brought forward by Dialectical reason. Or it is like taking an integral of a certain field density over all possible paths between two points. Thus Speculative reason subsumes into bilateral isomorphisms these directed unilateral relations and again brings peace to the concept, then to be seized again by the Understanding at a higher level.

In sections 2-9 we only consider elementary mathematics while in the remaining sections we consider advanced category theory.

### 3 First look at the Logic of Being

The first section of Hegel's Logic, the Logic of Being, involves an abstract exploration of the concept of space and the differential geometry used in mathematical physics. Hegel, who taught differential calculus both at high school and university, dedicates a long section of the Logic to the infinitesimal calculus, the notions of which illuminate many other passages of the Logic.

In the section on Being, in the parts involving the One and the Other, Limit, the Infinite, the One, and the successive transitions involved - all this suggests a connection to a universal construction in mathematics: that of a completion. We have a finite structure which is limited, incomplete in some determinate way. For instance a field may not be algebraically closed. Something is missing, something extrinsic that needs to become intrinsic (cf. the process of finite algebraic extensions, adjoining roots, etc.). Yet the finite completion, the finite adjoining of the missing aspects generates in turn its own incompleteness at the next level, and so on. This situation is only overcome by assimilation, by incorporation of this extension process, this outflow, into the structure itself - now invariant under this finite 'passing to the limit'. This 'incorporation' is itself a kind of higher 'limit', a limit of limits, so to speak (which has a universal property, or a minimality property). We find similar processes in measure theory (in the construction of the Borel  $\sigma$ -algebra, regular and complete measures) and analysis (completion and approximation theorems). Hegel states in the Encyclopedia Logic that the determinations of Being are exterior to each other, their process is the passing into another.

The transition for Being-for-self to Quantity recalls the proof of Urysohn's lemma. The main ingredient is the fact that in a locally compact Hausdorff space  $X$  if we have a compact set  $K$  contained in an open set  $U$  then we can find an open set  $V$  such that  $K \subset V \subset \bar{V} \subset U$ . This expresses  $K$ 's tendency to overcome its limitation relative to  $U$ . In the proof of Urysohn's lemma this process of overcoming the limit is multiplied to countably infinite sets indexed by the rationals and then completed into a continuous function, into continuous quantity. Somehow this relationship to the real numbers is implicit in the abstract concept of a locally compact Hausdorff space. There are analogous situations in which valuations, measures, uniparametric semigroups of automorphisms, emerge. For example for continuous functions with compact support Borel measures emerge from bounded positive linear functionals on spaces of such functions.

Pure Quantity or indifferent Quantity (apeiron) is topological, corresponding to what is implicitly determined by a variable, a sequence, a net (cf. the discussion in [13]). Attraction is aggregation, cohesion, expressed by the open sets of a topology. Repulsion is discreteness. The duality and mutual transition between the continuous and discrete is reflected in the fact that geometric structures give rise to algebraic structures and these in turn have their geometric realizations.

In the initial section of the Greater Logic on Measure there is a suggestion that Measure is a kind of conservation law; that which remains invariant under actual, possible or conceivable change and variation. Measure is related to mathematical physics; Hegel states that a Measure is not pure Quantity but Quantity in relationship to something exterior to itself. Hegel also raises the question of natural vs. artificial units of measure. He introduces gradualness (i.e. continuous change in quantity with surprising jumps in quality) and mentions the Sorites paradox. Hegel's interpretation might be couched in terms of locally constant sheaves (equivalent to covering spaces): local homogeneity and uniformity is reconciled with global non-triviality. Hegel's knotted line foreshadowed the modern notion constructible sheaf[11], the 'knots' corresponding to the stratification (cf. singular points of a variety, bifurcation set, etc.).

The section on Measure concerns also how systems combine into larger systems or split again, etc. Hegel uses chemistry and thermodynamics. It suggests the idea of program or function which can be integrated with different inputs producing different behaviors yet still maintaining its essence.

## 4 On Quantity

The indifference of Quality expresses an infinitesimal local Quality around a point. The idea of an open set in which the actual size is completely irrelevant, the local homogeneous

quality. This can be understood in terms of a basis of a topology  $\tau$ : a family of open sets such that each open set  $U$  containing a point  $x$  contains an element of the basis (containing  $x$ ). The ordinary topology of  $\mathbb{R}^n$  has a basis given by open balls of radius  $\frac{1}{n}$ . The Hegelian 'indifference' is expressed by the fact that we can remove any finite (or even some infinite sequences) of such balls from the basis without affecting the topology defined.

The definition of topology is inseparable from the concept of continuity. And yet the ordinary topology has an element of discreteness, or rather, can be generated by a discrete sequence.

The concept of continuity, in our view, is tied to that of sheaf, in particular to the concepts of gluing or synthesis. In its most rudimentary form it is the condition that any open set must be able to be written as a union  $\bigcup_{i \in I} B_i$  of open sets of a basis.

Consider a category  $C$  of open sets. And let  $D : I \rightarrow C$  be a diagram, for instance, consisting of open balls containing a given point. In this case the point is a 'limit' of the diagram in some sense, but not in the category  $C$ . But we can define the notion of  $c$ -limit - the idea here is that the limit point is defined implicitly through the complement of this maximal open set.

Given a diagram  $D : I \rightarrow C$  for  $I$  a directed set, we say that an open set  $V$  in  $C$  is a  $c$ -limit of  $D$  if i) for any object  $i$  in  $I$  we have that  $F(j) \cap V \neq \emptyset$  for some  $j \prec i$  and any open set  $V'$  satisfying this condition is contained in  $V$ . For example, for a sequence of balls centered at the origin the complement of the origin is the  $c$ -limit.

Hegel's treatment of repulsion and attraction recalls the separation axioms in general topology. And the concept of connectivity is also directly involved with separation. The extremes are that of the coarse and discrete topologies. In the coarse topology everything is merged together, we cannot separate things. In the discrete topology not only can we separate everything but each point is its own separation (this atomization is a form of alienation that features in many crucial moments of the Phenomenology of Spirit).

Hegel's 'Units' are like the proximate species of a genus. In Aristotle genus is a continuum, like matter. The species carve up the genus into pieces (which themselves become further genera). But all species form a spectrum, a continuum in sharing the quality of the proximate genus. All open sets (at least basic ones) should share the same quality. The topology is the quality. In the sheafification construction of a presheaf, a section of the constructed sheaf is essentially a unity, a gluing of local sections, a kind of averaging out into a locally homogeneous quality.

Hegel's treatment of number in the section of Quantum is noteworthy. Given a non-empty finite set  $S$  for every  $s \in S$  we have  $S = S' \cup \{s\}$  with  $S' \subset S$ . This is what Hegel seems to call  $s$  being a limit of  $S$ . It matters not which  $s$  is used. Hegel's whole approach suggests an intuitive continuum-based phenomenological view of number, numbers as connected objects which expresses the internal homogeneity and indifference between objects.

Different total orderings of a finite set are equivalent. For each we have  $S = \{n \in N : n \leq \max S\}$ . Orderings are external, imposed. Recall also the external relation of Frege's equinumerous relation. A number is the set of all sets equinumerous to a given set (the extension of the number) and again the precise choice of this set is irrelevant.

Hegel was certainly prescient about the relationship between geometry and arithmetic, the discrete and the continuous. Modern mathematics has confirmed this. Numbers do not add themselves, they are added from outside. Arithmetical operations are imposed from without, much like the category theoretic view of algebraic structures (for instance a natural number object). We could also wonder if intensive quantity corresponds to viewing the real numbers as a set with an order. Hegel seems to have anticipated in this discussion the axiom of induction in Peano Arithmetic.

Homotopy (in algebraic topology) is the passage of Quantity into Quality. It is a changing of shape and size which preserves - and thus defines - a certain quality.

A simplicial set is an abstraction of a topological space, it is a category theoretic abstraction

of a geometric form (i.e. a polytope). But it is a geometric form which contains within itself the process of its own genesis or assemblage (cf. the geometric realisation functor associating a topological space to each simplicial set).

The category of sets *Set* is an exterior, abstract, discrete concept (Hegel's concept of number seems to be very set theoretic), but the category of simplicial sets *sSet* represents a greater cohesion between parts and qualitative structure and determination. The morphisms between objects in a simplicially enriched category instead of being a mere set become a space.

## 5 On Being, Quality and Quantity

Consider a category *C* with only one object *A*. Is *A* then an initial or terminal object ? Not necessarily either because  $hom(A, A)$  can contain other morphisms besides  $id_A$  (i.e. we might say it has internal symmetries, it is not absolutely simple). If *A* is a terminal object then  $hom(A, A) = \{id_A\}$ , but then *A* is also an initial object. And if *A* is an initial object then  $hom(A, A)$  again must be  $\{id_A\}$  and so *A* is also a terminal object. This is one (very simple) illustration of the passage between Being and Nothing and Nothing and Being.

If *C* is a category with two objects *A* and *B* and if *A* is initial and *B* is terminal (there is a canonical  $t : A \rightarrow B$ ) then if there is a morphism  $f : B \rightarrow A$  then *A* and *B* must be isomorphic. This is a simple prototype of the quotient construction. But let *C* have three objects, initial 0, terminal 1 and *A*. Then it follows from these hypotheses that the canonical  $0 \rightarrow 1$  must factor a unique way as  $0 \rightarrow A \rightarrow 1$ . Now *A* is allowed to have internal symmetries ( $hom(A, A)$  need not be  $\{id_A\}$ ). And postulating a  $1 \rightarrow A$  means that "*A* has an element". Thus *A* is now a Something.

On a very simple level in a category we find already the embodiments of the basic Hegelian concepts: Being-in-self, Being-for-other and Being-for-self. Objects, considered in themselves, without arrows, without relations, are very poor and empty. The only morphism an object *A* must have is  $id_A$ . We could almost say that  $id_A$  represents *A* (in some formulations of a category as a partial monoid we can even identify objects with these morphisms).  $id_A$  represents the bare minimal immediacy of a quality (or being at this stage). This is being-in-self. Now the existence of a morphism  $f : B \rightarrow A$  represents a relation between *A* and *B*, it represents *A*'s being-for-other, *A*'s being relative to *B*. Likewise  $g : A \rightarrow B$  represents *B*'s being relative to *A*. The composition of these two  $f \circ g : A \rightarrow A$  is in general non-trivial (distinct from  $id_A$ ) and represents being-for-self, a more complex self-relation which is mediated by relations to the Other.

Much topological intuition and anticipation of modern geometry and logic seems to be found in Hegel's Science of Logic. For instance Hegel writes: the boundary of a thing both belongs and does not belong to it (we discuss the relationship to the Heyting algebra of open topological sets [13] and the logical significance of the boundary in a topological sense). Points are seen both as limits of lines and generators (in the algebraic and indeed Lie group sense). The pure something in Determinate Being (when we abstract it from its Limit) is likened to a local homogenous quality (open set). The limit is seen as an interface with the environment. Constitution (for instance rational thought is called the constitution of man) implies a barrier to be overcome and already a certain rudimentary invariance under change. Hegel even says points, lines, surfaces have a "dialectical tension".

Infinity is the negation of the negation (the connection to the double negation topology in topos theory[12] is worth exploring - it is connected to density and indeed probably to self-similarity and scaling). But there is a simple illustration that might be of some interest. Consider the Heyting algebra of open sets of a topological space (which is in general not a Boolean Algebra so we do not have  $A \vee \neg A$  or equivalently  $\neg \neg A \rightarrow A$ ). The negation of an open set *A*,  $\neg A$ , is defined as the interior of its complement ( $int A^c$ ). We have  $A \subset \neg \neg A$ .

But not in general an equality.  $\neg\neg A$  here represents the Hegelian infinite, which is essential dynamic, it is about evolving, overcoming barriers. Now look at the open set  $(0, 1) \cup (1, 2)$ . If we think of this open interval as having a living, flowing nature, what would the natural tendency be of this open set ? It would be to fill in the whole (the gap  $\{1\}$ ), to cohere and merge into  $(0, 2)$ . But if we calculate  $\neg\neg((0, 1) \cup (1, 2))$  we get precisely  $(0, 2)$ . The open sets which are invariant for the operation of double negation are the regular open sets.

There is more that could be said about the One in terms of infinitesimals, stalks of sheaves and germs of functions and their unfoldings. In particular about how the One expels and generates other Ones. Hegel indicates that he is thinking of Leibniz's monads, of infinitesimal points.

On an elementary level we can think of the One as a fundamental system of neighbourhoods around a point or equivalently as the germ of a point  $p$  which is an equivalence class in a quotient construction. Thus it must have representatives actual open sets  $U$  containing  $p$ . But then  $U$  itself generates (or represents) germs for all the points  $q$  in  $U$ . Thus each germ will generate a multiplicity of others. A slightly more advanced way of looking at this is in terms of germs of functions (around a singularity) Each germ of a function determines a universal unfolding which gives rise to qualitative local discontinuities around the point (a catastrophe set). Thus the homogeneous strata = attractions and the germs of submanifolds representing the catastrophe sets represent repulsion. In catastrophe theory one speaks of a "conflict" of attractors.

The idea of a germ of a point  $p$  is quite a good illustration of Being-for-self (the One). The germ of a point is defined as an equivalence class (hence via a quotient construction) of all open neighbourhoods  $U$  containing  $p$ . Thus  $U$  and  $V$  determine the same germ if  $p$  is in  $U$  and  $V$  and  $V$  is contained in  $U$ . For  $p$  to be a germ it needs to enter into relationship with the ambient space, it needs the topology of the space. It cannot be a germ merely in itself. Thus to define the germ we need some open set  $U$  (the germ is for-another). This  $U$  is posited. But at the same time we can deny and discard this  $U$  and replace it by a different one  $V$  as long as it is equivalent to  $U$  (for instance  $V$  is contained in  $U$  and contains  $p$ ). This is the moment of negation. That is, the germ is not this, not that, etc. It has abrogated complete determination via any specific open set. The whole net or local basis around  $p$  represents the 'bad infinity'. The quotient construction that defines the germs represents finally the return-to-self and a unity.

This germ seen as a One has a "dialectical tension" which we can associate topologically with the idea of instability. It has to unfold and stabilize in the ambient space but by doing so it reveals its internal contradictions and movement of attraction and repulsion. Maybe there is a connection to symmetry breaking in theoretical physics.

Besides the quotient construction another fundamental construction is that of completion (but completions and limits in general are often defined using quotient constructions). Take the category of open sets of a topological space. Then we can define a category theoretic diagram  $U_1 \rightarrow U_2 \rightarrow U_3 \rightarrow \dots \rightarrow \dots$  (equivalent to a net, or local basis) which represents a germ at a given point. But, as we already remarked, the limit in the category-theoretic sense does not in general exist. Thus we need to complete the topology by adding infinitesimal neighbourhoods. So if  $G(p)$  represents the germ-object and  $U$  some neighbourhood we now have canonical morphisms  $G(p) \rightarrow U \rightarrow G(p)$  which represents return-to-self.

These germs or infinitesimals have both the nature of discreteness (they are point-like in the sense that for a "decent" topology two distinct infinitesimals are represented by disjoint open neighbourhoods around their respective points) and continuity. Open sets are obtained from infinitesimals by "integration", a kind of synthesis or gluing together of infinitesimals (cf. the Leibniz notation for the integral). Thus the category of Quantity is born. This is also related to the sheafification construction discussed above.

## 6 Measure from Hegel to Thom

The section on Measure in the Science of Logic is highly suggestive from the point of view of modern topology. We argue that modern differential topology and singularity theory represents a development of key intuitions and concepts found therein.

The relationship between Quality and Quantity in Measure recalls not only that of a physical field spread out through space-time, but the general concept of a sheaf. The base category is often space, or space-time, or some control space, while the target category is phenomenological, qualitative although having in turn a quantitative aspect. The base is extensive, the fiber intensive. The further development in this section of the Logic - and most specially the concept of Nodal Line - appears to us as a prototype of Thom's Catastrophe Theory expounded, for instance, in his book Mathematical Models of Morphogenesis. Hegel offers an important insight on the essential co-dependence between the qualitative and quantitative which has consequences for applied mathematics. Strictly determined systems have to be studied qualitatively. But qualitative studies are only meaningful and fruitful in the context of a specific determined object. Thus we must employ qualitative concepts to talk about a sculpture (for instance locally the quality of the curvature, the topology of the surface levels) but a merely global qualitative (i.e. topological) study would identify it with a ball. In other words, the topological exists to study the metrical and the metrical has to be studied using the topological. The same goes for differential equations and dynamical systems. As Hegel wrote: the Quantum is Quantity (in the sense of indifferent quantity) endowed with Quality.

Hegel's discussion on the Sorites besides being related, as we mentioned, to locally constant sheaves, also invokes phase transitions in modern physics. And is not general relativity a partial realization of Hegel's project of deriving physics entirely from the properties of space and time ? Hegel mentions the influence on the observer on the experiment (in his discussion of thermodynamics) . The transition to Essence suggests that while applied mathematics is legitimate in its own domain and perspective, deeper scientific knowledge has to be found elsewhere - but this latter (whatever it be) must in all cases involve passing through a thorough understanding of the former.

Hegel's concept of Type suggests the image of a continuous map  $F : U \rightarrow \Phi$  for some phenomenological space  $\Phi$  where  $U$  represents the allowed variations of the independent parameter. Besides the connection to Thom there is also the more general connection to moduli spaces.

## 7 The transition to Essence and modern Physics

Generally speaking modern physics has a very Hegelian structure. In Newtonian mechanics we can start with simple postulates about invariance under Galilean transformations and the conservation of angular momentum 'emerges' as a consequence of the invariance of inertial frames under rotation. Starting from the invariance of the speed of light in special relativity we get that energy and momentum are united in a elegant way as a single 4-vector (which thus 'emerges') and that special relativity subsumes classical mechanics as a limit case when  $c \rightarrow +\infty$  (Aufhebung). There is also a further process of 'abrogation' in which concepts first considered static and absolute are then revealed to be relative. Being there (Dasein) is only being there through negation of the 'other'. This is exactly what relativity does by making time, length and mass no longer in-themselves but for-the-other (the observer). In classical quantum mechanics, starting from basic postulates about the wave function, observables and the evolution of the system we obtain that by passing to the classical limit we get an interpretation of the operators and the wave function in terms of classical Hamiltonian mechanics (including the wave function expressed in terms of the action  $S$ ). This is another case of 'Aufhebung'. The uncertainty principle (a surprising result) is also case of emergence. The uncertainty principle



interacts with the classical concept of angular momentum to give rise to an entirely novel concept / category: that of spin. Quantum mechanics (and specially quantum field theory) often abrogates previous concepts. Even in Bohm theory the concept of an individual particle is no longer tenable once we consider relativistic versions of quantum theory.

The narrative about the transition between a Newtonian absolute frame of reference and the relativity of referential frames is rich in philosophical consequences. Essence is negativity (this can be represented by the functor that collapses a category into the single category), the abrogation and vanishing of being which paradoxically is the retreat of being into itself, being reflected in itself, shining in itself, the realm of relation and mediation and positness. The Newtonian absolute frame of reference corresponds to the naive immediacy of being. Relativity negates this: this frame of reference does not exist, no frame of reference can be an absolute immediate representation of physics. Thus this negation carries over to all frames of reference, for each one of them relativity says: this is not physics. Physics must stand beyond all frames of reference, the depth beneath the surface appearance. As Gödel defended, relativity entails a certain form of phenomenism or idealism. However the essence must manifest, and from the negation of the absolute claims of reference frames follows that the essence must lie in the relation between the reference frames, that is, the movement and relativity between moments of Being, And in physics this web of relations corresponds exactly to representations of Lie groups (or principal bundles). And we have the further duality between the group itself and its representations which correspond to positing, Appearance, manifestation, Existence. The sections about Identity and Difference at the beginning of Essence are all about relations and specially equivalence relations. Physics can be considered as defined by equivalence classes modulo all possible frames of reference.

## 8 Essence as Systems Theory and Holology

We should seek an abstract treatment of the category of Essence (Wesen) whereby Being negates itself to enter more deeply into itself and prepare the way for becoming in and for itself in Concept. The categories of Essence correspond to the categories of classical metaphysics, but they also corresponds to Objective Spirit, to nature. In modern terms the proper abstract treatment of the category of Essence (if it is not to lapse back into Being) must involve among other things a general systems theory adequate for theoretical biology. For it is the living organism which gives us light on the categories of existence (as organism and system) and active substance. Living beings manifest, they have appearance and phenomena. They preserve themselves in their own negation. Biology cannot be reduced to physics and is essentially more than physics in the same way that mediated Essence cannot be reduced to immediate Being. Life is process and mediation. The theory of computation on one side is connected to formal logic. But on the other side it is a crude approximation of biocomputation, the computation of nature. What is a suitable mathematical model for biological systems that cannot be reduced to the general scheme of mathematical physics (sheaves, gauge potentials, jet bundles, PDEs, etc.) ? Biology cannot be reduced to physics because it cannot be described by sections of a bundle which evolve according to a closed manifold in a jet bundle, that is, exhibiting the local causality of PDEs or integral equations based on these assumptions. The 'space' involved may be such that the stalk at any 'point' (and the subsequent evolution thereof) depends on the information on the entire space. For instance  $X$  can be seen as a groupoid and we can think of the groupoid algebra product which for two elements is defined in terms of the entire groupoid. Let physics correspond to a temporal process  $\phi : T \rightarrow \Gamma(S)$  where  $\Gamma(S)$  are sections over some bundle-like structure over a 'space'  $X$ . This structure forms a certain kind of (commutative) algebraic structure. Then biology corresponds to a temporal process  $\beta : T \rightarrow B$  in which  $B$  is a (non-commutative) algebraic structure which is not isomorphic to sections of a bundle-

like object over any 'space'  $X$ . However  $B$  may have phenomenological 'representations' or 'projections'  $\pi : B \rightarrow \Gamma(S_\pi)$  for  $S_\pi$  a bundle-like structure over some space  $X_\pi$ . Thus living organisms have physical measurable manifestations but cannot be reduced to such.

Perhaps  $\infty$ -groupoids might play a role. Here we discuss some of the intuitions involved. Consider points in the plane. Internal equality between two (externally unequal) points  $a$  and  $b$ , written  $a = b$ , is seen as being witnessed by there being a continuous path from  $a$  to  $b$ . In this way reflexivity, symmetry and transitivity have natural interpretations (in fact we obtain a groupoid or more correctly a 1-groupoid). Note that there can be more than one path between two points. For a space  $C$  consisting of two disjoint 'chunks'  $A$  and  $B$  there is no path from a point of  $A$  to a point of  $B$ . There are two extreme situations. One is the discrete case in which no two externally distinct points can be connected by a path - this is the classical concept of a set. The other extreme is a connected (technically: 1-connected) space in which we can find a single point  $p$  such that  $p$  can be connected to any other point in the space. Thus the discrete space has the minimum of internal unity and the contractible space the maximum of internal unity. In general we can have a space with a certain number of connected components ('chunks'). If we view internal equality as an equivalence relation (and thus the space as a setoid) then the number of components is the number of equivalence classes.

We now explain how being connected is only the maximum of unity at the lowest level. Given two points  $a$  and  $b$  there is a space of all paths from  $a$  to  $b$  denoted by  $Path(a, b)$ . Only now in such a space 'points' are paths and the 'paths' are deformations between paths (homotopies). So given two paths  $p_1, p_2$  in  $Path(a, b)$  we have that  $p_1 = p_2$  is witnessed by there being a 'path' (i.e. deformation/homotopy) between paths  $p_1$  and  $p_2$ . Now the same story is repeated at a higher octave.  $Path(a, b)$  itself can possess the extremes of being discrete (set-like) or connected or anything between. From elementary algebraic topology we get examples of spaces which are connected but which for two points  $a$  and  $b$  there are paths  $p_1$  and  $p_2$  in  $Path(a, b)$  which cannot be deformed into each other (for instance on a torus). In the case where  $Path(a, b)$  is connected for every  $a$  and  $b$  the space is called contractible but we see now why we could also call it 2-connected. There are also closed paths or 'loops', elements in  $P(a, a)$ , and there is no a priori reason why these could not be discrete, not mutually deformable into another. Thus we might add something to our characterization of classical 'set'. If we think of a set as a collection of points or atoms, then these should not have interesting internal structure or symmetries and thus we add the condition that  $Path(a, a)$  be path-connected for every  $a$ : that is, all loops are internally the same. We can now continue this process considering deformations of deformations and so forth. If a deformation is a path between paths in  $Path(a, b)$ , i.e. an element in  $Path(p_1, p_2)$  where  $p_1, p_2 : Path(a, b)$ , then we can also consider for  $d_1, d_2 : Path(p_1, p_2)$  elements of  $Path(d_1, d_2)$ , that is to say, *deformations of deformations*. If we can keep iterating the path construction, then we obtain what is called an  $\infty$ -groupoid (this is only a rough description) which has a specific notion of  $n$ -connectivity for each level  $n$ . What kind of  $\infty$ -groupoid will have the maximum of connectivity or unity, i.e. how can we define a contractible  $\infty$ -groupoid? Clearly by requiring at each level that  $Path(x, y)$  for any  $x$  and  $y$  be path-connected, that is, that we have  $n$ -connectivity at each level  $n$ .

Now let us see how  $\infty$ -groupoids might illustrate the metaphysical categories in Essence as well as the philosophy of nature in Hegel. There is a lowest level of inorganic matter which corresponds to classical sets, thus to 0-discreteness. Then living beings have an organic unity which corresponds to 1-connectedness. Each part of a living body is connected to every other one on the lowest level, but can have quite distinct modes of connection. We can also think of this as there being the same life present in every part but functionally specialized. Next we come to mind which is a higher-order organism in that the same mind is present in every part in an essentially similar way (perhaps related to metacognition or "self-luminosity"), thus we

would postulate both 1- and 2-connectedness for instance. The failure of 3-connectivity could reflect the presence of time or sensation. We could also follow ancient metaphysics such as Plotinus and characterize the *nous* (seen as a unified space of all forms) as being  $n$ -connected for all  $n$ , thus a contractible  $\infty$ -groupoid, the ontological maximum of unity.

A fuller understanding and interpretation of the section on Essence and its relation to modern mathematical physics will be attained through thorough analysis of our use of differential models in science as well as the allied concepts of determinism and computability, specially with regards to the possibility of extending these concepts to other more general mathematical frameworks.

## 9 The quest for Notion

Perhaps a key to understanding Hegel's concept of Notion and the concept of Individual, Particular and Universal and their relationship - is to see how these concepts are embodied in the movements of Spirit in the Phenomenology of Spirit. That is, we view Notion as describing the structure and dynamics of a community of consciousnesses united in different ways into a higher consciousness wherein each individual also is fully identified with this universal consciousness. Although in the first part of Notion Hegel uses the terminology of the formal logic of his day, what he is getting at is much deeper. There is here the mirroring of the microcosm and the macrocosm, the human mind itself is like a community of minds. This suggests the theory of fractals as well as Alain Connes' non-commutative geometry - for these all concern interface between the local and global. There are two extremes: the global contained fully in the local (as in holomorphic functions) or the local completely emptied of any global information: this is the case of Penrose tilings which cannot be distinguished by considering only local information. Hegel in discussing Objective Notion mentions a system in which the whole is implicit in each particular determination: this is the case of holomorphic functions: the germ at each point completely determines the whole function (on a connected component containing that point) by analytic continuation and the whole completely determines the germ at each point. In general this is a case of a sheaf in which the restriction morphisms are isomorphisms. Holomorphic functions can be called holistic because they are uniquely determined by their germs, the whole is in the part. Change a holomorphic function locally and you change it globally. The global information on the function is contained implicitly in any local restriction or germ (which unfolds via analytic continuation). Thus we can say that the "same" germ is spread out across the whole domain of the function. The case of holomorphic functions corresponds to the global being contained in the particular (or local). The global is thus totally local. But there is also the opposite situation in which the local is emptied of any global information. The global is totally non-local. This is the case, as we mentioned above, for the space of Penrose tilings. It is impossible to distinguish between two tilings by looking at local patterns. This could also be brought into connection to non-locality in quantum theory.

The transition between Essence and Notion, involves the culmination into systems of reciprocal causality. It would be interesting to read this in parallel with Connes' discussion on how many classical constructions yield equivalence relations or groupoids for which classical analysis and geometry are inadequate - in which a conceptual leap is required by developing tools for a non-commutative concept of space (i.e. a more sophisticated generalization of space which upturns the classical relations between the local and the global). The natural topology on such non-commutative spaces defined as the quotient of an equivalence relation is the coarse topology. So the germ of each point is the space itself, in Hegel's terms, the Individual is the Universal.

Fractals and fractal calculus may well be worth exploring as a formal hermeneutic tool for Hegel's Logic. In the Encyclopedia Logic Hegel speaks of Objective Notion as undergoing a

division into parts each one which contains the totality.

For physics and systems theory the most developed and relevant sections in the Logic are found in the section on Object (mechanism, chemism and teology) and the first parts of the section of Idea (with regards to process and life). For the relevance to topology and geometry this is a good point of entry, with special focus on self-similarity (maybe in quantum field theory ?) and goal-oriented systems. The final parts of Idea are clearly about self-reference, self-knowledge, self-reproduction, self-production. Concept-Idea is both essentially self-referential (it is knowledge knowing itself, and knowledge that is being and being that is knowledge, and also process and goal) and self-productive as well as generative, in the sense that it generates or emanates nature.

## 10 Some additional considerations on Hegel' logic, consciousness and mathematics

The something and the other. In the Science of Logic Hegel thinks of the idea of two things bearing the same relation to each other and indistinguishable in any other way. Now a good illustration of this situation is found in the two possible orientations of a vector space. Each bears the same relation to the other and there is absolutely no way to uniquely identify one of them in distinction to the other. In the same place Hegel talks about the meaning of proper names and states that they have none.

Hegel's strategy. All of Hegel is based on the dynamics and structure of consciousness as it reveals itself to itself. And yet for Hegel this structure is at the same time 'objective': mere 'subjectivity' is seen as a failure and partiality of objective consciousness in not living up to its full objectivity or actuality (or knowledge and realization thereof).

Thus ideality and infinity are the key structure of a being which has developed to a point of being a subject.

Finitude and limit: a closed set. Yet the boundary also defines what the set is not (cf. our discussion on Heyting algebra of open sets, etc.). Thus the boundary contains implicitly its own negation.

Limitation : an open set (cf. analytic continuation). Limit outside itself.

The ought... manifestation of the germ of a space through a given open set representation of the equivalence class. Any particular one is insufficient and can be replaced by another which is also insufficient.

False infinity: taking simply the set (or diagram) of such open set representatives. True infinity taking the limit (equivalence class) or limit (in the categorical sense).

Degrees of interpenetration and transparency between the individual and the universal (and between self-consciousness and essence) in the Phenomenology of Spirit. From the rudimentary form in the ethical life to: the universal is in the individual, the individual in the universal and the universal is in the relation between individuals and the relation between individuals is in the universal (mutual confession and forgiveness).

Milne's notes on Class Field Theory has a quote of Chevalley (1940) which seems couched in Hegelian terms: the Abelian extensions of a number field are determined by the number field itself, the number field 'contains within itself the elements of its own transcendence'.

'Pure' category theory is very poor in results, like Hegel's poor, empty, abstract universal. But once we consider the particular, like Abelian or Monoidal or Model or Presheaf categories, things become very rich.

## 11 First steps in higher topos theory

Note that we are not implying that category theory is preferable to set theory as a foundation for mathematics or even for science in general. We are inclined to hold that dependent type theory is a good candidate for such a role.

From a categorical point of view what is the simplest object we can conceive ? The singleton category with only one object  $\star$  and only one arrow, the identity morphism  $id_\star$  on this object. All such singleton categories are equivalent and a singleton category is in fact the terminal object in the 2-category  $Cat$  of small categories. They are complementary because they emerge from right and left adjoints respectively (which are necessarily fully faithful) of the same unique functor  $\mathbb{T} : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \{\star\}$ .

$$\mathcal{C} \begin{array}{c} \xleftarrow{0} \\ \xrightarrow{\mathbb{T}} \\ \xleftarrow{1} \end{array} \{\star\}$$

This gives rise to adjoint modalities  $\emptyset \vdash \star : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ . We can see the singleton category as the most rudimentary being, the Etwas, something.

The first section of Hegel's logic, the logic of being, involves an abstract exploration of the concept of 'space' and the differential geometry used in mathematical physics. Hegel, who taught differential calculus both at high school and university, dedicates a long section of the Logic to the infinitesimal calculus, the notions of which illuminate many other passages of the Logic. We start with what can be considered the archetype of the concept of space, the adjunct quadruple associated to a the category of presheaves over a category  $C$  with a terminal object. We call this space proto-space.

$$PrShv(C) \begin{array}{c} \xrightarrow{\Pi} \\ \xleftarrow{Disc} \\ \xrightarrow{\Gamma} \\ \xleftarrow{CoDisc} \end{array} Set$$

Here  $\Gamma(P) = P(1)$ . It is very instructive to work out these adjoints  $\Pi \vdash Disc \vdash \Gamma \vdash CoDisc$  explicitly. We have that  $Disc(X)(A) = X$  for all objects  $A$  in  $C$  and  $Disc(X)(f)$  is  $id_X$  for any  $f : A \rightarrow B$  in  $C$ . We have that  $\Pi(\mathcal{A}) := \bigcup_{U \in Obj C} \mathcal{A}(U) / \sim$  where  $\sim$  is the equivalence relation which identifies  $s$  and  $s'$  over  $U$  and  $U'$  respectively if there are  $f : V \rightarrow U$ ,  $g : V \rightarrow U'$  with  $s_V = s'_V$ . If  $\Omega$  is the subobject classifier for presheaves on a topological space  $X$  then  $\Pi(\Omega)$  gives the connected components of  $X$  in the usual sense. We have finally that  $CoDisc(X)(U) = \mathcal{P}X$ . If we have a set map  $f : \mathcal{A}(1) \rightarrow X$  then we can define a morphisms of presheaves  $f^\flat : \mathcal{A} \rightarrow CoDisc(X)$  given by  $f^\flat(U)(s) = \{x \in X : \exists w \in \mathcal{A}(1), w_U = s\}$  for  $s \in \mathcal{A}(U)$ . This quadruple is closely related to the above diagram for terminal and initial objects. The functors in the quadruple arise by taking the left and right Kan extensions along  $\mathbb{T}$  and  $1$ . Thus we have the development of the concept of proto-space from that of being. The terminal object is the limit of the empty diagram. (Co)limits and adjunctions are all special cases of Kan extensions. Thus starting from the 2-category of all categories we can derive the concept of proto-space employing only Kan extensions. Kan extensions express dialectical reason's process of passing to the other while preserving an essential mediating connection. Proto-space then assumes various form through various localisations giving rise to the sheaf toposes.

In general the adjoint quadruple does not carry over to a topos obtained by localisation. The condition of being cohesive is what guarantees this. One example of a cohesive topos are sheaves on a cohesive site. Thus we are lead spontaneously to the concept of cohesive topos as the right categorical notion of space.

But it should be stated that  $Disc$  represents to movement towards discrete quantity or

repulsion of units and *CoDisc* represents the movement towards continuous quantity and coalescence of units.

The Yoneda embedding  $C \rightarrow PrShv(C)$  expresses that each category  $C$  unfolds into a proto-space. This unfolding of categories in the category of Being proceeds to something extrinsic, as a passage to the other. Dialectical reasoning asks for how something is constructed, for repressed history. A paradigm is that we can have diagrams into the category without the corresponding (co)limit existing. But to think of a diagram and the concept of limit is already to posit the limit as something other and lacking in the category but nevertheless proceeding from it. Thus the complete and cocomplete category of presheaves given by the Yoneda embedding is a genuine Hegelian progression.

The key to understanding higher category theory is passing the above considerations into the correct generality of enriched category theory. A cosmos is what categories are enriched in. The above is the special case for the cosmos *Set*. Thus we should think of enriched presheaves, the enriched functor category between an enriched category and the cosmos itself seen as an enriched category.

Homotopy is the passage of quantity into quality. It is a changing of shape and size which preserves and thus defines a certain quality. Model categories are simply categorical abstractions where all constructions in classical homotopy theory can be carried out. The quality associated to a variation in quantity is expressed as the localisation yielding the homotopy category.

A simplicial set is an abstraction of a topological space, it is a categorical abstraction of a geometric form (i.e. a polytope). But it is a geometric form which contains within itself the process of its own genesis or assemblage, analogous to G-code (cf. the geometric realisation functor associating a topological space to each simplicial set). Category theory enriched over the cosmos of simplicial sets is currently seen to be the correct choice for the doing homotopy theory and differential geometry at the highest level of abstraction.

We must investigate the deeper significance of the simplex category  $\Delta$  and its associated augmented simplex category  $\Delta_a$  used to define simplicial sets.  $\Delta_a$  has the natural structure of a strict monoidal category and  $[0, 1]$  has a natural monoid structure. This situation is universal in that monoidal categories  $B$  with monoid objects  $M$  are classified by functors  $\Delta_a \rightarrow B$  sending  $[0, 1]$  to  $M$ . Similarly we can obtain a classification of monads in a 2-category (curiously enough equivalent lax functors from the terminal object category). Perhaps  $\Delta_a$  can be viewed as a higher qualitative categorical determination of the natural numbers expressing the exteriorisation and unfolding of the unit, one, monas (Hegel includes a short digression on Pythagoreanism in the section on Quantity).

*Set* is an exterior, abstract, discrete concept (Hegel's concept of number seems to be very set theoretic), but the category of simplicial sets *sSet* represents a greater cohesion between parts and qualitative structure and determination. The morphisms between objects in a simplicially enriched category instead of being a mere set become a space.

For a good introduction to higher topos theory see

<https://ncatlab.org/nlab/show/geometry+of+physics+--+categories+and+toposes>

To understand Higher Topos Theory it is important to master (among other things) the basics of the following subjects in category theory:

1. Monoidal categories
2. Enriched categories (including ends and coends and enriched Yoneda lemma)
3. Model categories (including combinatorial model categories and homotopy (co)limits)

For 1 and 2 a good reference is Part I of Birgit Richter's *From Categories to Homotopy Theory*.

For 3 it is the book chapter *Homotopy theories and model categories* by W. G. Dwyer and J. Spalinski.

But there is more. One must feel very at home with simplicial sets (and their connection to

homotopy types) which play a central role in Higher Topos Theory. Finally one must master the basics of Grothendieck toposes.

Instead of ordinary (set-enriched) model categories we work with model categories enriched over simplicial sets  $\mathbf{sSet}$  (seen itself as a category enriched over simplicial sets and when endowed with its classical (Quillen) model structure its fibrant-cofibrant objects are called  $\infty$ -groupoids). Instead of presheaves to sets we work with simplicial set enriched functors from the opposite of a simplicial set enriched category to simplicial sets. A key result is Dugger's theorem, the simplicial presheaf analogue for combinatorial model categories of the characterization of sheaf toposes as left exact full subcategory localizations of presheaves - itself a generalization of the presentation of an object by generators and relations.

So Higher Topos Theory is Topos Theory done (homotopically) over  $\mathbf{sSet}$  rather than  $\mathbf{Set}$ .

It seems we can give a more geometric interpretation of the nerve of category  $C$  (a canonical way of extracting an simplicial set ) given usually in terms of composable sequences of arrows. For take three composable arrows  $f, g, h$ . Think of  $f$  and  $g$  as being in the plane but  $h$  directed perpendicularly into space. Then we get 3-simplex in  $N(C)_3$  with faces  $(f, g, g \circ f)$ ,  $(g, h, h \circ g)$  and  $(g \circ f, h, h \circ (g \circ f))$  where we view a pair of composable arrows together with their composition as a triangle, i.e. a 2-simplex. Our intuition is that the nerve of a category keeps track of all commutative diagrams and each such diagram is a geometric object.

Of course there are competing definitions of (models of)  $\infty$ -groupoids besides the  $\mathbf{sSet}$ -based one (Kan complexes) which itself is only one possible choice for shapes (which include cubical and cellular sets).

All this suggests philosophically that our different concepts and models of what a 'space' is are special embodiments of a single 'pure' concept which is yet to be determined. Note that homotopy type theory connects  $\infty$ -groupoids to (identity) types/ propositions or spaces of proofs/functions/computations.

## 12 On certain concepts of Category Theory

Is there a connection between the double-negation topology, the dense topology and the sheafification functor  $P^{++}$  ? The concept of sheaf is related to 'locality' and to the 'flowing' or 'variation' of one object relative to another. The locality aspect is seen in Mitchel-Bénabou semantics, in the interpretation of  $\forall$  and  $\exists$  (reflected in their peculiar natural deduction rules) and the 'flowing' aspect can be appreciated as follows. When we define Dedekind reals in the internal language of a topos of sheaves over a topological space it turns out that these reals correspond to the sheaf of continuous functions over this topological space. So the sheaf condition has a subtle connection to continuity.

Consider the quotient category construction: we wish to construct a new category out of an old one in which a certain class  $\Sigma$  of morphisms become isomorphisms. We are focusing on certain aspects of the objects ('equating' objects that share this aspect) and forgetting others. The category is seen according to as it is in a certain aspect. This is analogous to projection, for instance given, an idempotent linear operator. Now the following is remarkable. From quotient categories we are lead to the concept of a calculus of fractions and for this to work to the concept of reflection . But problems arise because the quotient construction can create more isomorphisms than is desired. Thus we require  $r$  to be left exact (preserving finite limits) and we arrive at localisations. Under certain conditions this amounts to a closure operator and factorisation system. Under certain conditions reflective subcategories correspond to idempotent monads (via their Eilenberg-Moore category). In type theory an idempotent monad defines a modality. Idempotent monads are the analogues of projection operators which focus on certain aspects of a being while negating others. We can order all (co) reflective subcategories of a category and subcategories which are both reflective and coreflective, the

inclusion having both left and right adjoint.

Four functors which form three adjunctions is the basis of Schreiber's theory of adjoint triples and the *aufhebung* relationship which is a pre-order having as bottom element the triple based on initial and terminal objects considered in a previous post. In this pre-order there is a series of functors from solid to elastic to cohesive topoi and finally to set (which includes the global sections functor).

Compactness is a generalisation of the concept of a finite set analogous to being finitely generated in algebra. Finitude or some control over 'size' is fundamental to define presentable and accessible categories, small objects, compact objects, generator, etc.). One idea is that any object can be given by a colimit of a diagram of generators. Many important categories are not small, their homsets are classes. So we need a way to control this largeness by having it determined in a some way by smallness, just as the generators do for an algebraic structure.

Consider the free completion or cocompletion  $\mathcal{C} \rightarrow PShv(\mathcal{C})$ . Absence of a (co)limit represents the 'bad infinity' which is overcome in the canonical completion (like the algebraic closure of a field). The presheaf category admits a further 'sheafification' functor  $PShv(\mathcal{C}) \rightarrow Shv(\mathcal{C})$ . This functor is a kind of localisation which dissolves global information (cf. quantum entanglement) and reduces it to information present in an infinitesimal neighbourhood. Consider the case of the presheaf (which is not a sheaf) of constant functions on a topological space and observe what the sheafification functor does. If this presheaf were a sheaf then if we had two disconnected open subsets and if there were a section on the union of these subsets then the value on one would completely determine the value on another. For sheaves, the global is built from local information in a coherent way.

## 13 Topos as quotient

In Aristotle's *Categories* a division is made between discrete and continuous quantity. If we visualize numbers - discrete quantity - in a spatial way, then spatiality is related to divisibility, to the formation of quotients involving equivalence relations. If we take 0 and 1 then there is a space between them and we would like to name the "points" in this space and are thus forced to "invent"  $1/2$  with the additional caution that  $1/2 \cong 2/4 \cong 4/8 \dots$ . This abstract construction is often a stumbling block for children learning mathematics. Modern algebraic geometry springs from Descartes' theory of studying geometrical figures by means of algebraic equations (or polynomials). We can study the behavior of varieties in a small vicinity of a point - the topos of the point - analogously by quotient constructions such as localisation and completion. There is also a similar concept of localization of a category. A full subcategory  $i : D \rightarrow C$  is a localization if there is a left adjoint  $r$  to  $i$  preserving limits. If furthermore  $r$  is left exact then giving a localization is the same as giving a *calculus of fractions*, a construction analogous to rationals discussed above where the morphisms of the category are replaced by equivalence classes of certain pairs of morphisms  $(f, g)$ . We remarked how subobjects  $Sub(A)$  of an object  $A$  can be seen as a generalized space. It turns out that giving a localization on a category is the same as giving a *universal closure operator* on  $Sub(A)$  for every object  $A$ . This closure operator is a generalisation of the closure operator of ordinary topology. For a detailed discussion of the topics of this section see [10][Ch.7]. The inverse image sheaf functor we considered has a powerful expression in the context of derived categories of Abelian sheaves and these are also given by a localization of the homotopy category of complexes [11][ch.1]. In fact modern homotopy theory is centered around the interplay between different kinds of simplicial structures and model categories<sup>1</sup>. These "model" a homotopy theory which can be defined as a category with a class of morphisms - weak equivalences - we wish to take as isomorphisms. We

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<sup>1</sup>The notions of fibration and co-fibration can be seen as a generalization of what it means for a space to be respectively "inside" and "over" another space.



form the homotopy category by localising such categories at weak equivalences. Certain classes of models form themselves a category and have in turn a natural notion of weak equivalence. Thus they can be seen as a "homotopy theory of homotopy theories" [16] [p.82], surely the most complex evolution of the ancient concept of topos to date. We will return to homotopy theory in our final section about mereology.

The category  $Set^{C^{op}}$  of presheaves over a category  $C$ , which is simply the category of functors from  $C^{op}$  to  $Set$  which are not required to satisfy any "gluing conditions", can be seen as a sort of *materia prima*. Given a category  $C$ , endowing  $C$  with a Grothendieck topology is the same as defining a universal closure operator on  $Set^{C^{op}}$  and the associated localization is precisely the Grothendieck topos, the category of sheaves on  $C$ .

## 14 Mereology

To prepare the main discussion of this section we make some introductory remarks about *homotopy type theory* and *higher category theory*, in particular *higher topos theory*. Homotopy type theory, an extension of the constructive type theory of Martin-Löf, was first proposed by Voevodsky as an alternative foundations for mathematics suitable for computer-assisted formalization and verification. For each type there is a whole hierarchy different levels of "equality" analogue to the series of homotopy groups  $\pi_i(X)$  of a topological space<sup>2</sup>. In [37] Urs Schreiber uses higher toposes to formalize theoretical physics.

Higher category theory is based on homotopy theory, thus on model categories but from the perspective of enriched category theory and simplicial sets. Instead of ordinary (i.e. set-enriched) model categories we work with model categories enriched over simplicial sets  $sSet$  (seen itself as a category enriched over simplicial sets. When endowed with its classical (Quillen) model structure its fibrant-cofibrant objects are called  $\infty$ -groupoids). Instead of presheaves of sets we work with simplicial set enriched functors from the opposite of a simplicial set enriched category to simplicial sets. A key result is Dugger's theorem, the simplicial presheaf analogue for combinatorial model categories of the characterization of sheaf toposes as left exact full subcategory localizations of presheaves (see the next section for a discussion of this) - itself a generalization of the presentation of an object by generators and relations. So higher topos theory is topos theory done (homotopically) over  $sSet$  rather than  $Set$ <sup>3</sup>.

There are competing definitions of (models of)  $\infty$ -groupoids besides the  $sSet$ -based one which itself is only one possible choice for what are called *shapes* (which include cubical and cellular sets). All this suggests philosophically that our different concepts and models of what a 'space' is are special embodiments of a single 'pure' concept which is yet to be determined. Homotopy type theory connects  $\infty$ -groupoids to types, spaces or 'sets' of proofs/functions/-computations.

There are interesting connections that can be made between both ordinary and higher topos theory and mereology<sup>4</sup> (for a good reference see [39]). Homotopy type theory also related to

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<sup>2</sup>The linearly ordered real interval  $I$  plays a central role in homotopy theory. The concept of connectivity associated to it is pathwise connectivity (which can also be extended to Topos Theory[31]).

<sup>3</sup>It seems we can give a more geometric interpretation of the nerve of category  $C$  (a canonical way of extracting an simplicial set ) which is defined usually in terms of composable sequences of arrows. For three composable arrows  $f, g, h$  we think of  $f$  and  $g$  as being in the plane but  $h$  directed perpendicularly into space. Then we get 3-simplex in  $N(C)_3$  with faces  $(f, g, g \circ f)$ ,  $(g, h, h \circ g)$  and  $(g \circ f, h, h \circ (g \circ f))$  where we view a pair of composable arrows together with their composition as a triangle, i.e. a 2-simplex. Our intuition is that the nerve of a category keeps track of all commutative diagrams and each such diagram is a geometric object

<sup>4</sup>Can we express Aristotle's basic logico-ontological suppositions in terms of modern mereology ? Let us take a generalized organicist approach to the existence of wholes. We assume strictly finite models. Let us write  $PP'xy$  if there is no  $z$  such that  $PPxz \& PPzy$ . Then for Aristotle there are only the following two basic kinds of instances of  $PP'$ . The first kind includes that of a certain kind of part of a living organism or

important problems regarding identity, equality, intensionality and extensionality.

In mereology the parthood relation  $P$  generally has the properties of a partial order which is a very special case of a category. Here we suggest that some core mereological concepts make sense in the more general context of a Grothendieck topology on a category. Suppose we considered arrows  $f : B \rightarrow A$  in a category as expressing generalized parthood and read them as  $A$  is an  $f$ -part of  $B$ . For  $g : C \rightarrow B$  then by composition  $C$  is a  $f \circ g$ -part of  $A$ . First, let us investigate the concept of sieve, mereologically speaking. A sieve on  $x$  is a set (or class) of parts  $y$  of  $x$ ,  $Pyx$ , such that if  $z$  is a part of  $y$  then  $z$  also belongs to this set.

$$\text{Sieve}(A, x) \equiv \forall y.((y \in A \rightarrow Pyx) \& \forall z. Pzy \rightarrow Pzx)$$

A sieve on  $x$  is thus a set of parts of  $x$  plus all the parts of those parts.

A covering sieve is a generalization of fusion:  $x$  is to be seen as a generalized fusion of any one of its covering sieves. To justify this we argue that the three axioms for a Grothendieck topology (see [12] for the definition of Grothendieck topology) make sense for fusions. If  $z$  is a fusion of the  $\phi(x)$  and  $Pyx$  then we can consider  $\phi_y(x)$  (the  $y$ -restriction of  $\phi(x)$ ) expressing elements which are overlaps of elements which satisfy  $\phi(x)$  with  $y$ . Then we should have by the first axiom that  $y$  is the fusion of the  $\phi_y(x)$ .

Suppose  $z$  is a fusion of the  $\phi(x)$ . And consider a  $P$ -sieve on  $z$  given by  $\psi(y)$ . If for every element  $x$  which satisfies  $\phi(x)$  we have by the second axiom that  $x$  is a fusion of the  $\psi_x(y)$  then  $z$  is also a fusion of the  $\psi(y)$ .

Finally each  $z$  is the fusion of all its parts: this is the third axiom

An important aspect of contemporary mereology involves holology, the study of different types and degrees of wholeness in systems. The concept of higher groupoid is relevant to holology. In Martin-Löf type theory there is an extrinsic and an intrinsic concept of equality. The intrinsic concept (written normally  $\Gamma \vdash t : A = A$ ) is what we shall mainly consider here. It can be given a topological (and higher-categorical) interpretation which is of some interest to mereology. Here we only give a rough description of some of the intuitions involved. Consider points in the plane. Internal 'equality' between two (externally unequal) points  $a$  and  $b$ , written  $a = b$ , is seen as being witnessed by there being a continuous path from  $a$  to  $b$ . In this way reflexivity, symmetry and transitivity have natural interpretations (in fact we obtain a 'groupoid' or more correctly a 1-groupoid). Note that there can be more than one path between two points. For a space  $C$  consisting of two disjoint 'chunks'  $A$  and  $B$  there is no path from a point of  $A$  to a point of  $B$ . There are two extreme situations. One is the discrete case in which no two externally distinct points can be connected by a path - this is the classical concept of a set. The other extreme is a connected (or 1-connected) space in which we can find a single point  $p$  such that  $p$  can be connected to any other point in the space. Thus the discrete space has the minimum of internal unity and the contractible space the maximum of internal unity. In general we can have a space with a certain number of connected components ('chunks'). If we view internal equality as an equivalence relation (and thus the space as a setoid) then the number of components is the number of equivalence classes.

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being a part of a concept (for instance the parts of geometric concepts). The second kind involves the relation between an individual and its immediate species and a species and its immediate superior genus. Abundant evidence can be adduced that Aristotle had a very organicist or at least geometric/topological approach to concepts, patterned somewhat after his biological theories. Genera and species are not conceived of in a strictly extensionalist manner, but do have associated extensions (modally conditioned). Thus for Aristotle the only true 'wholes' are individuals and species/genera. The status of parts of living organisms is an open question. Also, are the only genuine parts of a genus its subordinate species? But surely the arc segments of a circle are not species of circle. Our view is that this approach is inadequate because it conflates under the same concept both classical parthood and the species-genera relation. A more general framework is required with more than one mereological primitive.

But being connected is only the maximum of unity at the lowest level. Given two points  $a$  and  $b$  there is a space of all paths from  $a$  to  $b$  denoted by  $Path(a, b)$ . Only now that 'points' are paths and the 'paths' are deformations between paths (homotopies). So given two paths  $p_1, p_2$  in  $Path(a, b)$  we have that  $p_1 = p_2$  is witnessed by there being a 'path' (i.e. deformation/homotopy) between  $p_1$  and  $p_2$ . Now the same story is repeated at a higher octave.  $Path(a, b)$  itself can possess the extremes of being discrete (set-like) or connected or anything between. Indeed from elementary algebraic topology we get examples of spaces which are connected but which for two points  $a$  and  $b$  there are paths  $p_1$  and  $p_2$  in  $Path(a, b)$  which cannot be deformed into each other. In the case where  $Path(a, b)$  is connected for every  $a$  and  $b$  the space is called contractible but we now see why we could also call it, for example, 2-connected. We note that there are also closed paths or 'loops', elements in  $P(a, a)$ , and there is no a priori reason why these could not be discrete, not mutually deformable into another. Thus we could add to our characterization of classical 'set'. If we think of a set as a collection of points or atoms, then these will not have interesting internal structure or symmetries and thus we could add to the definition of classical set the condition that  $Path(a, a)$  be connected for every  $a$ : that is, all loops are internally the same. We have seen the recurring motifs: connected and discrete. To this we can add external notions: there being no elements whatsoever in the space (type), there being exactly one according to external equality (singleton) and there being exactly two elements (for instance the type of classical Boolean values).

We can now continue this process considering deformations of deformations and so forth. If a deformation is a path between paths in  $Path(a, b)$ , i.e. an element in  $Path(p_1, p_2)$  where  $p_1, p_2 : Path(a, b)$ , then now we are given for  $d_1, d_2 : Path(p_1, p_2)$  elements of  $Path(d_1, d_2)$ , that is to say, *deformations of deformations*. A structure like what we have here, in which we can keep iterating the path construction, is called an  $\infty$ -groupoid (this is only a rough description). We get thus a notion of  $n$ -connectivity for each level  $n$ . What kind of  $\infty$ -groupoid will have the maximum of connectivity or unity, i.e. how can we define a contractible  $\infty$ -groupoid? Clearly by requiring at each level that  $Path(x, y)$  for any  $x$  and  $y$  be connected, that is, that we have  $n$ -connectivity at each level  $n$ .

A main idea of the Univalent Foundations of Mathematics (also called homotopy type theory) is that mathematics is better done over  $\infty$ -groupoids rather than over sets. This brings unity between logic, category theory and geometry and also a natural way of developing computer software for formalizing and checking proofs. The concept of 'h-type' is directly related to what we called  $n$ -connectivity.

The framework discussed above has applications to ontology and metaphysics - specially the Aristotelic and Neoplatonic systems, and in particular to the philosophy of biology and mind. There is a lowest level of inorganic matter which corresponds to classical sets, thus to 0-discreteness. Then living beings have an organic unity which corresponds to 1-connectedness. Each part of a living body is connected to every other one on the lowest level, but can have quite distinct mode of connection. We can also think of this as there being the same life present in every part but functionally specialized. Next we come to mind which is a higher-order organism in that the same mind is present in every part in an essentially similar way (perhaps related to metacognition or self-luminosity), thus we would postulate both 1- and 2-connectedness for instance. The failure of 3-connectivity could reflect the presence of time or sensation for instance. We could also follow ancient metaphysics such as Plotinus and characterize the *nous* (seen as a unified space of all forms) as being  $n$ -connected for all  $n$ , thus a contractible  $\infty$ -groupoid, the ontological maximum of unity.

C. Ortiz Hill's book[14] contains an interesting discussion on equality and identity in Frege and Husserl. Per Martin-Löf and Frege played similar roles as founders of radical new systems of mathematical logic and foundations of mathematics. As we just saw in Martin-Löf type theory we have two notions of equality. One is extrinsic and corresponds to (absolute) sameness

(or identity) and satisfies Leibniz’s law. The other is internal, and corresponds to equality, sameness according to some aspect<sup>5</sup>, which we interpret in terms of paths. Leibniz’s law for internal equality becomes problematic and corresponds topologically to ‘liftings’ or ‘transports’.

Extensional internal equality between functions is interpreted as a homotopy and we get the analogue of the notion of homotopy equivalence between two functions: each function is the inverse of the other up to homotopy (extensional internal equality).

Husserl criticized Frege for conflating sameness and equality; extensional equality is a kind of equality and Law V expresses this conflation as an extensionality principle. But Law V is powerful as a foundation of mathematics. We saw that Martin-Löf and Voevodsky agree with Husserl and keep the distinction between sameness and equality. However a certain controlled and transposed version of the Fregean approach becomes the Univalent foundations of mathematics. Instead of conflating sameness with extensional equality we conflate in a precise way internal equality with equivalence (which involves likewise extensional equality). More precisely the univalence axioms reads:

*Internal equality itself is equivalent to equivalence.*

## 15 Aufhebung in Type Theory

Consider the Barendregt Cube or more specifically the system of logics studied in Jacobs book ‘Categorical Logic and Type Theory’ which starts with simple type theory and culminates in higher-order dependent type theory which subsumes all the rest. There is a process in which each level subsumes the previous one in particular through reflection-into-self, the prototype being the subobject classifier wherein Prop becomes a Type. The culmination of the Barendregt cube is  $\lambda C$ . There is a parallel with Hegel’s development of Concept (Begriff). In the simple typed lambda calculus we have the classical division between subject and predicate  $t : T$ ,  $t$  is of type  $T$ ,  $t$  is a  $T$ , which corresponds to the division between term and type. The development along the directions of the cube expresses the increased dependency of terms on types, types on terms (and types on types) until the distinction is all but subsumed and abolished in  $\lambda C$ . There is only one pure ‘type’  $\Box$  which expressed the Concept. Jacob’s book allows us to trace this in terms of fibered categories.

We propose that we extend the Barendregt cube incorporating substructural logics via monoidal categories and generalisations of linear logic. This involves replacing the cartesian product with the monoidal product and losing weakening and contraction. Note that symmetric monoidal categories are a primary example of the internalization of the hom-sets of a category within that category.

Consider how predicate logics are extended via propositions-as-types. The poset (or pre-order) for Prop becomes a full-blown category of proof-terms. This is like the Understanding in the Hegelian dialectic that wishes to erase the past, the temporal dynamic constitutive and genetic process of a concept. The understanding says what matters is what is proven not the process of the proof (repressed history). Against this dialectical reasoning forces the proof itself to be remembered and speculative reasoning incorporates the proof-process into a concept, thus turning propositions into types and proofs into terms.

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<sup>5</sup>it would be interesting to compare this to Aristotle’s statement of the law of non-contradiction in the *Metaphysics*.

## 16 Kant and sheaf theory

Lawvere's theory of smooth toposes and their use for formulating differential geometry and differential equations can be seen as an unveiling of fundamental synthetic a priori categories and principles. The adequacy and conformity to scientific experience (in the spirit of critical idealism) is a vital dimension in the philosophical deployment of category theory.

The sequence seems to be : topos  $\rightarrow$  ringed topos  $\rightarrow$  lined topos  $\rightarrow$  smooth topos. Our task is to elucidate the phenomenological and categorical (in the philosophical sense) meaning of the concept of topos. Also to understand why the internal version of the concepts of commutative ring, commutative algebra, linear map (cf. Weil algebras and the Kock-Lawvere axiom) and an infinitesimal version of simplicial objects (used for defining the dg-algebra of differential forms) appear to be of so fundamental and vast a scope as a priori conditions for mathematical physics and other branches of natural science. And how are we to understand Kant's concept of space in the light of synthetic differential geometry, it being point-free ? Seeing a vector field on  $X$  as an infinitesimal deformation of the identity map on  $X$  seems very intuitive.

Kant's theory of schematism could be interpreted in particular as implying that any line-shape  $R \rightarrow X$  must be seen as a solution of a differential equation; we give the Weil algebra a generative dynamic interpretation.

Let us look at the first two antinomies of pure reason in the transcendental dialectic, involving time and composition. The point-free nature of space presupposes for the argument to work. Can causality involving a previous moment of time be captured in terms of the infinitesimal path  $D$  via a prolongation principle ? The infinity which cannot be object of a synthesis appears to be best captured by a set dense set for  $<$ . Otherwise why cannot for instance the points  $\frac{1}{n}$  be objects of a synthesis ?

Kant appears to be saying that every state of the universe must have a temporally previous state but at the same time there cannot be infinitely many previous states to a given state.

We must compare the antinomies to various intuitionistic principles and classical principles not intuitionistically valid.

It could be tempting to see a sheaf as a derived concept relative to an abstract bundle (which is a very Kantian notion). Sheaves are sections of some bundle. But we must check if this carries over for Grothendieck topologies too, that there is an equivalence of categories between sheaves over a site and étale bundles defined not in terms of ordinary topology but in terms of Grothendieck topologies (as in étale cohomology). However there are other entities in geometry which are more naturally seen as sheaves than as a bundles: for instance the sheaf of continuous or holomorphic functions. A sheaf is essentially a phase space, a space of phenomenal possibilities which expresses how these possibilities flow locally and cohere. But in actual situations the number of different sheaves (over a given space) is very definite and determinate. For instance, sheaves of smooth functions on a manifold and smooth  $k$ -forms and other functions relevant to analysis. Many of these actual sheaves form natural complexes, so much so, that the complex itself can be seen as adequate kind of generalized sheaf (cf. the derived category). Since it is the cohomology of the sequence that mostly of interest, complexes are identified if they have the same cohomology : this is the basis of the derived category constructions which turns morphisms of complexes module homotopy into 'fractions' where in the denominator quasi-isomorphisms are inverted.

But how are actual sheaves, sheaves of concrete interest, 'generated' , beyond the basic ones discussed above ? By functors generated by continuous maps  $f : X \rightarrow Y$ . Of great interest is the study of neighbourhoods of fibers  $f^{-1}(x)$  as  $x$  varies.  $Y$  is often seen as parametrization space or base space. Hence the presheaf on  $Y$  given by  $V \rightarrow \Gamma(f^{-1}(V), F)$  for  $F$  a sheaf on  $X$ . This carries over to a derived functor  $Rf_*$  taking complexes of sheaves on  $X$  to complexes of sheaves

on  $Y$  by which is studied the cohomological variation of the fibers along  $Y$ . This is a main source of the generation of interesting sheaves, the sheaves used in practice. Another source of is the functor  $f^{-1}$  by which is studied the cohomology in an infinitesimal neighbourhood of the images of open sets via  $f$ . These two functors are abstract versions of integration and differentiation. Another important operation is the "restriction" composition  $R_* j j^{-1}$  for an inclusion  $j : V \rightarrow X$ . This takes a sheaf  $F$  and yields a new sheaf which, roughly speaking, takes into account only the nature of  $F$  on  $V$  or in infinitesimal neighbourhoods of  $V$ .

Thus a category of sheaves becomes interesting and intelligible by its relation to other categories of sheaves. So considering at once the 2-category of sheaf-categories, or more generally, toposes, is very natural and imposes itself in the nature of things. The adjunction between toposes and locally presentable categories is discussed in Marta Bunge, Aurelio Carboni, The symmetric topos, Journal of Pure and Applied Algebra 105:233-249, (1995).

Having a whole category of sheaves leaves a vast amount of elbow-room. A category of sheaves represents a spectrum of different spaces of possible manifestation (cf. how locally constant sheaves can be identified with covering spaces). The category of sheaves over a given topological space represents every mode of phenomenal possibility space of that space - thus in a way the category can be identified with the space itself.

A remarkable property of sheaves is their homogeneity for scaling. Given an open set  $U \subset X$  we get automatically from a category of sheaves on  $X$  a new category of sheaves on  $U$ ,  $\Gamma_U : Shv(X) \rightarrow Shv(U)$ .

Categories do not apparently have the vertical hierarchical structure of the classical genus-species classification. For instance: group is a species of monoid and abelian group is a species of group. There are corresponding categories Mon, Grp and Ab which form a chain of sub-categories. Our construction from our paper can be interpreted in terms of successively taking equivalence classes of equivalence classes of equivalence classes. In category theoretic terms this translates as a sequence of categories  $C_0, C_1, C_2, \dots, C_n$  and a sequence  $F_1, F_2, \dots, F_n$  of sets of morphisms in  $C_{i-1}$  such that  $C_i$  is the quotient category of  $C_{i-1}$  via  $F_i$ . Consider how a given infima species might be described in terms of a prototype  $P$ , membership of an object  $X$  being ensured by the existence of a deformation  $f : P \rightarrow X$ . We can also think of an interpretation in terms of  $\infty$ -groupoids but it is more subtle; it is a top-down approach using connected components and  $n$ -contractibility.

But sections of a sheaf are like individuals of a given infima species. The category of sheaves is like the genus of the infima species. Then the 2-category of (small) sheaf categories is like the yet higher genus of this genus. Functor categories are like the category of relations.

So: section  $\rightarrow$  sheaf  $\rightarrow$  sheaf category  $\rightarrow$  2-category of sheaf categories. Aquinas (in De Ente et Essentia) views genus as a space of possibilities rather than as a minimal matter to which difference is added as a form. Difference determines or 'picks out' a latent possibility of the genus. This agrees with the concept of sheaf and category: we choose a section of a sheaf or a definite sheaf in the category of sheaves.

Formal axiomatic metaphysics in the sense of Zalta all depends on a multi-valued logic having truth-values  $\Omega^W$  where  $W$  represents possible worlds. Or rather, consider that  $W$  must be endowed with a topology or Grothendieck topology so we can consider  $\Omega$  for  $Shv(W)$ .

Thus we have a fundamental axiom of metaphysics: the set of possible worlds must be endowed with a topology. The idea of alternative situation always depends on a more or less strong continuous deformation of the actual world. If a sentence  $P$  holds at a world  $w$  then it must hold in some neighbourhood  $U(w)$  of  $w$ . Thus it is natural to capture modal logic by the topos of sheaves over  $W$ ,  $Shv(W)$ .

In the section on understanding in the phenomenology of spirit there are many interesting considerations about 'force' and exteriorization and the unity of motion determined by a law. The germ of a sheaf is the unity of between interiority and exterior manifestation (for there is

not definition for the point itself independently of its neighbourhood). Let  $W$  be a category  $\mathbb{W}$  with a Grothendieck topology. Then take modal logic to be a functor  $m : \mathbb{W} \rightarrow \mathbf{Cat}$ .

Topos theory is (very roughly) the study of how logic coheres and varies with space and time and possibility. All predicates  $X \rightarrow \Omega$  have a domain which is a 'type'  $X$ . But in general  $X$  is a sheaf. Types as spaces can be expressed as 'types as sheaves'. For instance a type parametrized by possible worlds. Thus predicates are in this case coherently parametrized according to possible worlds. But notice how in general the objects  $X(U)$  can vary for  $U$  in the base category. If  $X$  were an atomic type of sets of individuals then the actual individuals could vary according to the possible world. An equivalent way to see this is as the subobject fibration in which we view propositions on  $X$  in correspondence with  $\text{Sub}(X)$ .

Zalta's encoding could be described as a morphism  $enc_X : PX \rightarrow PX$ .

Jean Hyppolite lays emphasis on Hegel's positing of 'the identity of identity and difference'. But it is difficult not to think here of the univalence axiom: 'the equivalence of equivalence and identity'. Hegel's logic, despite this going against the surface intention of Hegel himself, may well be capable of a formal axiomatic treatment. This will depend on a proper account of identity and equality.

In Jacobs' Categorical Logic and Type Theory there is the idea of giving a categorical semantics for untyped lambda calculus ( $\lambda$ -categories on p.155-156) related to Scott's reflexive objects. We take an object  $\Omega$  in a Cartesian closed category for which  $\Omega = \Omega \rightarrow \Omega$ . This expresses that  $\Omega$  has a mediation within itself, is self-mediating. Is in and for itself.

If conscious experience is normally present in unreflected 'globs', the goal of analytic insight is to unmask and be continuously aware of the ternary structure present in consciousness  $\bullet \rightarrow \bullet$  and its subsequent higher-order unfoldings.

We mentioned before the archetypal structures and processes of consciousness. Here is an incomplete tentative list (with an implicitly Kantian basis):

Synthesis - gluing, covers, the sheaf-condition = extensibility on  $j$ -dense objects for a topos with a Joyal-Tierney topology.

- different orders of wholes (higher groupoids)

Self-reflection - a system which can represent (partially at least) higher order aspects of itself within itself. This is the original synthetic unity of apperception = I know that I am knowing. This is found in recursive definitions, inductive types, the successive powers of the  $\lambda$ -cube wherein external aspects of the system become internalized and internally represented, also the subobject classifier, truth-value object  $\Omega$  in a topos. See also our post on the meaning of the logical connectives.

Return-to-self, that is, Kant's trinary structure in the CPR. This is related to the negation of the negation, double negation as the third (synthesis). In topos theory this relates to the dense topology and in particular to forcing. The idea is simple. In rough terms it is as follows: consider  $U \Vdash \phi$  as signifying that the sentence  $\phi$  holds in region  $U$ . We define  $U \Vdash \neg\phi$  if  $\phi$  does not hold on any subregion  $V \subset U$ . Then  $U \Vdash \neg\neg\phi$  means that for any subregion  $V \subset U$  we choose we must have that there exists a  $W \subset V$  such that  $W \Vdash \phi$ .

Double-negation can also be connected to temporality: something must pass to reveal itself, *ti to einai, quod quid erat*.

## 17 Miscellany about Hegel and category theory

Let  $C$  be a category representing the totality of individual consciousness and their relations. Then for a given individual consciousness  $A$  we have i) the set  $\text{hom}(A,A)$  (individual, internal relations), ii) the set  $\text{hom}(A,B)$  relations between two individual consciousnesses, and finally iii) the slice categories  $(C \downarrow A)$  and  $(C \uparrow A)$  whose objects are all possible relationships between

A and its environment (all the other objects in the category C) and whose morphisms are relationships between objects "from the point of view of A". Also the process could be repeated, taking slice-categories of slice-categories and so forth.

Notice how holistic the definition of limit and colimit are. The property of a cone C being the limit of a diagram depends in an essential way on the entire enveloping category (i.e. a universal property)

Elementary toposes represent consciousness and the mind while I think that Grothendieck toposes (toposes of generalized sheaves) are a very abstract representation of physics (and perhaps also systems theory and biology). The underlying site (or in particular topological space or groupoid) represents the most general concept of space-time, the sheaves on it are generalizations of the fields in physics.

How are we to understand from a Hegelian perspective two objects being isomorphic ? It is like the self and the other become mutually determining in the 'true infinite', or the reciprocal causality before the transition to concept. A connected groupoid in which all objects are isomorphic to each is much like 'quantity' in the Logic. In a quotient category we introduce new morphisms thereby forcing certain morphism to become isomorphisms. Taking the quotient is like moving forward in the processing through the categories in the Logic.

Now the section on Measure on the Logic is highly suggestive from the point of view of modern topology. For modern differential topology and singularity theory represents a development of key intuitions and concepts found in this section.

First of all: the relationship between quality and quantity recalls that not only of physical field spread out through space-time, but the general concept of a sheaf. The base category is often space, or space-time, or some control space, while the target category is phenomenological, qualitative although having of course having in turn a quantitative aspect. The base is extensive, the fiber intensive. The further development in this section of the Logic - and most specially the concept of Nodal Line - corresponds very closely to Thom's general theory expounded in Mathematical Models of Morphogenesis (which also has close connections to Aristotle). There is a strong connection here to my paper on continuity and topos in Aristotle (which was published in *Intentio*). On the other hand, Hegel offers an important insight on the essential co-dependence between the qualitative and quantitative which has consequences for modern topology, singularity theory, differential equations and dynamical systems. Strictly determined systems have to be studied qualitatively. But qualitative studies are only meaningful and fruitful in the context of a specific determined object. In other words the topological exists to study the metric and the metric has to be studied using the topological. The same goes for differential equations and dynamical systems and singularities. As Hegel wrote: the quantum is quantity (the topological, in the indifferent) endowed with quality.

The discussion on the sorites and 'phase transitions' is prescient. It recalls locally constant sheaves (covering spaces) - for instance if we analytically continue the complex square root around the origin we do not end up where we started, in terms of the section /quality...

Hegel also offers interesting considerations on the philosophy of physics (and philosophy of science in general). Is not general relativity a partial realization of Hegel's project of deriving physics purely from the properties of space and time ? Hegel's observation of the influence on the observer on the experiment (in his discussion of thermodynamics) is prophetic. The transition to essence suggests that while applied mathematics is legitimate in its own domain and perspective, deeper scientific knowledge has to be found elsewhere - but the latter must pass through the thorough understanding of the former.

Hegel's concept of type is very interesting. It suggests that it is like the image of a continuous map  $F : U \rightarrow \Phi$  where  $U$  represents the allowed variations of the independent parameter.  $F(W)$  a type much like in homotopy type theory, because endowed with a topology and a concept of homotopy and continuous variation. Besides the connection to Thom there is also the more



general connection to moduli spaces.

We need to delve deeper into Hegel's concept of indifferent quantity. This is clearly the concept of germ around a point: a fundamental system of neighbourhood, a direct set, etc.

Open and dense. This is related to transversality - again nodes. And to stability, expression of mediated quantity invariance of quality.

Topological, open variation, quality, perfection, optimization again involves quantity.

Consider an analogy : day is to night as life is to death. Surely in any analogy there is implicit a correspondence, a set of functions which takes the pairs to each other:  $F: \text{day,night} \rightarrow \text{life,death}$  and  $G: \text{life,death} \rightarrow \text{day,night}$ . Consider the statement: death is the night of life. If this is so then surely: night is the death of day and vice-versa. We take *of life* and *of day* to be the functors  $F$  and  $G$  respectively - here we venture that 'life' and 'day' designate the whole genus, the set of both elements of the respective pairs. Thus it would make sense to day : day is the life of day and life is the day of life. And we read this as  $\text{death} \rightarrow F \text{night} \Leftrightarrow G \text{death} \rightarrow \text{night}$  which (together with the case for day and life) corresponds to the definition of an adjunction (we can assume we are in a groupoid in which 'is' is an isomorphism). We can also write symbolically:

$$\frac{\text{day}}{\text{night}} = \frac{\text{life}}{\text{death}} \Leftrightarrow \text{day} \times \text{death} = \text{life} \times \text{night}$$

## 18 On Quantity

The indifference of quality which expresses an infinitesimal local quality around a point. The idea of an open set in which the actual size is completely irrelevant. The local homogenous quality. This can be understood in terms of one form of the definition of basis of a topology  $\tau$ . It is a family of open sets such that each open set  $U$  containing a point  $x$  contains an element of the basis containing that point. The ordinary topology of  $\mathbb{R}^n$  has a basis given by open balls of radius  $\frac{1}{n}$ . The Hegelian 'indifference' is expressed by the fact that we can remove any finite (or even some infinite sequences) of such balls from the basis without affecting the topology defined by the basis.

The definition of topology is inseparable from the concept of continuity. And yet from the exposition above we see that even the concept of the ordinary topology has an element of discreteness, or rather, can be generated by a discrete sequence.

The concept of continuity, in our opinion, is intimately tied to that of sheaf, in particular with that of gluing or synthesis. In its most rudimentary form it is the condition that any open set must be able to be written as a union  $\bigcup_{i \in I} B_i$  of open sets in a basis.

Consider a category  $C$  of open sets. And let  $D : I \rightarrow C$  be a diagram, for instance, balls containing a given point. In this case the point is a 'limit' of the diagram in some sense, but not in the category  $C$ . However we can define the notion of  $c$ -limit.

Given a diagram  $D : I \rightarrow C$  for  $I$  a directed set, we say that an open set  $V$  in  $C$  is a  $c$ -limit of  $D$  if i) for all all object  $i$  in  $I$  we have that  $F(i) \cap V \neq \emptyset$  and any open set  $V'$  satisfying this condition is contained in  $V$ . For example, for a sequence of balls centered at the origin the complement of the origin is the  $c$ -limit.

Separation and attraction. Recall the separation axioms in general topology. And the concept of connectivity is also directly involved with separation. The extremes of the coarse and discrete topology. In the coarse topology everything is merged together, we cannot separate things. In the discrete topology not only can we separate everything but each point is its own separation.

Hegel's 'units' are like the proximate species of a genus. In Aristotle genus is a continuum, like matter. The species carve up the genus into pieces (which themselves become further genera). But all species form a spectrum, a continuum in sharing the quality of the proximate genus. We can think of a connected groupoid of connected groupoids. Hegel's unit is like a

object in a category. The category of open sets we discussed above. All open sets (at least basic ones) should share the same quality. The category, the topology, is the quality.

Thus we should view quantity as a Kantian process of subjective synthesis - which we already interpreted in terms of the sheaf-gluing process. In the sheafication process we see that a section is essential a unity, a gluing of local section.

Hegel's treatment of number in the section of Quantum is curious. Indeed given a non-empty finite set  $S$  for every  $s \in S$  we have  $S = S' \cup \{s\}$  with  $S' \subset S$ . This is what Hegel seems to call  $s$  being a limit of  $S$ . It matters not which  $s$  is used. Hegel's whole approach suggests an intuitive continuum-based phenomenological view of number, numbers as connected groupoids which expresses the internal homogeneity and indifference between objects.

Different total orderings of a finite set equivalent. For each  $S = \{n \in N : n \leq \max S\}$ . There are external, imposed. Also external relation of Frege's equinumerous relation. A number is the set of all sets equinumerous to a given set (the extension of the number ?) ... and again this set is irrelevant. An equivalence class. A groupoid.

Hegel is certainly prescient about the relationship between geometry and arithmetic, the discrete and the continuous. Modern mathematics has confirmed this. Numbers do not add themselves, they are added from outside. Arithmetical operations are imposed from without. This is just the category theoretic view of algebraic objects in a category or a natural number object !

Hegel seems to have anticipated induction.

Intensive quantity, degree. Here we have number as the real numbers, as a set with an order. Now limit is exterior. Numbers are not dense, point units in relation to others.

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